About a month later Sartaj informed Mathur that a person close to Chohan was keen to meet him. His name was Suchcha Singh, said Sartaj, and he was a Canadian citizen of Indian descent. Mathur agreed. They decided to meet at Martin's Tavern in Georgetown for lunch.

When Mathur saw the strongly-built man striding to the table where he and Sartaj were chatting, he was stunned. Suchcha Singh was none other than the man who had sat beside Chohan just a month ago, supposedly one of the leader's key advisors.

'Although I greeted him with a smile when Sartaj introduced us, questions just rained in my head,' Mathur said. 'Was he here as a messenger for Chohan? Why did he want to meet me outside Chohan's orbit? Was this some kind of plan devised by Chohan to lure me into a trap? He had told Sartaj that he had already met me once, though we had not been formally introduced. Now I was looking at the prospect of building a contact inside Chohan's network.'

While Sartaj ordered the food, Suchcha Singh told Mathur in chaste Hindi that he had been impressed with his interaction with Chohan the month before and had been planning to meet him since then. As the conversation continued, Mathur learned more about his surprise guest. Suchcha had been a civil engineer at a private firm in Vancouver when Operation Blue Star, the military operation on the Harmandir Sahib Complex in Amritsar in June 1984, turned his life upside down. He turned naturally towards the Khalistan movement and his educational and professional qualifications catapulted him into Jagjit Singh Chohan's network. In March 1985, he became Chohan's closest advisor. Suchcha's other job was to coordinate and maintain the relationships among the various militant Sikh factions in the